

User Manual

COS 301 - Capstone 2026
Capstone Project: EquityLens
By The Big Five



Project Name: EquityLens
Client: Amazon Web Services (AWS)
Team: The Big Five (TB5)

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1. Welcome to EquityLens

EquityLens is a free web application that helps South African retail investors understand what they own. You upload your investment portfolio and EquityLens turns it into a clear picture of what your investments are worth, how healthy your portfolio is, how you are performing against the JSE, which news stories moved your stocks, and what deserves your attention. An AI assistant is built in so you can ask questions about your own portfolio in plain language and get plain-language answers.

- EquityLens never gives financial advice. It shows you information and explains what the numbers mean, but it will not tell you what to buy or sell.
- EquityLens never asks for your brokerage login. Your portfolio enters the system only through files you upload or numbers you type. The system cannot touch your actual investments and only analyses a copy of the information you give it.

2. Before You Start

You need three things:

- A modern web browser - Chrome, Firefox, Edge or Safari, on a computer, tablet or phone. The interface adapts to all screen sizes.
- An email address you can access, for the verification code that activates your account.
- An authenticator app on your phone, such as Google Authenticator or Microsoft Authenticator, for the two-step verification that protects your account.

3. The Landing Page

Your first sight of EquityLens is its landing page headlined “See past the surface of your portfolio.” It exists to show you what the product does and why it matters before you have created an account.

From the navigation bar at the top you can jump to:

- How it works - an interactive portfolio simulator. Flip between three example portfolios and see how EquityLens’s analysis exposes what each one really holds underneath its funds including how supposedly different funds can quietly hold the same few companies.
- Features - the four things EquityLens does for you, shows the underlying companies in your funds, scores your portfolio’s health, ties news to your holdings, and lets you ask the AI assistant directly.
- Why it matters - a walk through concentration risk with illustrative figures showing how a portfolio that looks diversified can fall hard when its overlapping holdings fall together.
- Help Centre - guides and frequently asked questions.
- Sign in/Get started - for returning and new users respectively.

Select Get started (or Analyse my portfolio button) to create your account.

4. Creating Your Account

1. From the landing page select Get started. The registration page opens.
2. Enter your full name, email address, and a password. Your password must be at least 8 characters and include an uppercase letter, a lowercase letter, a number and a special character.
3. Select Register. EquityLens emails a 6-digit verification code to the address you entered.
4. On the verification page, enter the 6-digit code from the email and submit it.
5. You'll see a confirmation that your account is active, and you'll be taken to the sign-in page.

If the code doesn't arrive within a couple of minutes, check your spam or junk folder. If the code is rejected as invalid or expired, the field clears and you can try again.

5. Signing In with Two-Step Verification

EquityLens protects your account with two steps: your password, plus a 6-digit code from an authenticator app on your phone. A stolen password alone is not enough to reach your data.

The first time you sign in:

1. Enter your email and password on the sign-in page and select Sign in.
2. EquityLens shows a QR code. Open your authenticator app, choose “add account” (Or usually a + button), and point your phone’s camera at the QR code. If you can’t scan, select the option to reveal the setup key and type it into the app instead.
3. Your authenticator app now shows a 6-digit code for “EquityLens” that changes every 30 seconds. Enter the current code on screen to prove the pairing worked.

Every subsequent sign-in:

1. Enter your email and password.
2. When prompted, open your authenticator app and enter the current 6-digit EquityLens code.

If you type the code incorrectly or the code rolls over while you type the form tells you and lets you try again with the new code.

To sign out, use the sign-out control at the top-right of any page.

6. Finding Your Way Around

Once signed in, every page shares the same layout.

The sidebar (left edge. On a phone it is opened with the menu button) is how you move between the five areas of EquityLens:

- Dashboard - your portfolio (Section 7).
- Portfolio - your holdings in detail and where you import data (Section 8).
- Analytics - the financial indicators (Section 9).
- News - news stories connected to the stocks you own (Section 10).
- AI Assistant - ask questions about your portfolio (Section 11).

The Topbar:

- The theme toggle (sun/moon icon) switches between dark and light themes.
- Sign out.

7. Dashboard

The Dashboard answers four questions in one screen: What am I worth? Am I healthy? How am I doing against the market? What needs my attention?

If your portfolio is empty, the Dashboard says so and points you to the Portfolio page to import your data (Section 8) and everything below comes alive once you have.

Portfolio summary (top of page). Your total portfolio value in Rand, your overall gain or loss, today's movement, and a summary of how your portfolio moved today and which holding drove it.

Portfolio health. A score out of 10 built from four ingredients you can see individually: Diversification of your holdings, how exposed you are to sector, your single-stock concentration risk, how many sectors your portfolio is stretched across and your performance against the benchmark.

Action Centre., EquityLens flags what deserves attention. Each item explains the risk in plain terms and links you straight to the place where you can look into it.

Performance vs the JSE. A chart of your portfolio's value over time against the JSE All Share Index, with your return, the benchmark's return, and the difference. EquityLens records one snapshot per day, so this chart grows richer the longer you use it.

Sector allocation. A breakdown of your portfolio by sector. Select a sector to see which of your holdings are in it.

Your holdings. Every position with its ticker, company name, sector, quantity, purchase price, current price, current value, and profit or loss in Rand and percent - gains in green, losses in red.

Today's insights. Which holdings drove today's gain or loss, and recent significant moves in your holdings.

Watchlist panel. A quick view of the stocks you're watching but don't own (Section 12).

8. Portfolio

Open Portfolio in the sidebar. There are two ways to get your holdings into EquityLens.

Option 1 - EasyEquities PDF statement.

1. Download a statement PDF from EasyEquities.
2. On the Portfolio page, select Import and choose your PDF.
3. EquityLens reads the statement right in your browser - the file itself never leaves your device - and extracts your holdings, transactions, dividends and statement details.
4. A preview shows exactly what was found. Check it over.
5. Confirm, and your portfolio appears - holdings, transaction history, dividend records and all.

Option 2 - Excel template.

1. Select Download Excel template on the Portfolio page and fill in your holdings in the labelled columns.
2. Upload the completed file, check the preview, confirm.

After importing, the Portfolio page becomes detailed: statement summary, largest and smallest holdings, allocation breakdown, trading activity, cash flow, dividend income, and costs.

9. Analytics

Open Analytics in the sidebar. This page calculates financial indicators from your actual holdings and live market data which professionals use, each explained in plain language.

The seven indicators:

- Sharpe Ratio - are your returns worth the risk you're taking?
- Sortino Ratio - the same question, but only counting downside risk (the kind that hurts).
- P/E Ratio - how expensive each share is relative to the company's earnings.
- CAPM Expected Return - what return the market's logic says a holding should deliver for its risk.
- Altman Z-Score - a company financial-health warning system: safe, grey zone, or distress.
- Beta - how much a holding swings compared to the JSE as a whole.
- RSI - whether a stock has recently been bought (or sold) unusually hard: overbought, neutral, or oversold.

Hover over or click on any indicator's name and an explanation appears telling you what it means and how to read your number. Values are colour coded, positive, neutral, negative with using each indicator's standard thresholds.

If there isn't enough data to calculate an indicator for a holding its card says N/A with a short reason instead of showing a made-up number; and if a calculation fails, only that card shows an error.

10. News

Open News in the sidebar. EquityLens shows you news connected to the stocks you own.

Each article shows its headline, source, publication time, a badge for the related stock in your portfolio, and how that stock's price moved. Selecting an article opens the full story in a new tab at the original publication.

You can narrow the list by categories.

If the news service itself is temporarily down you will see a clear message.

11. Using the AI Assistant

Open AI Assistant in the sidebar. This is where you ask questions about your portfolio in ordinary language.

Asking a question. Type into the box at the bottom (“Ask the assistant...”) and press enter. The assistant answers using your actual data. If you are unsure you can select one of the suggested prompts shown when the chat is empty.

Your conversations are saved. The panel beside the chat lists every conversation you’ve had, newest first, each with an automatically generated title. Select one to pick up where you left off, use + New Chat to start fresh. You can rename or delete any conversation by selecting the pen or trashcan symbol respectively when hovering over a chats name.

The assistant will not tell you to buy or sell anything.

If the assistant can’t answer your question either due to the service being down or the nature of the question you will see an error message and can simply try again.

12. Your Watchlist

The watchlist is for stocks you want to keep an eye on.

- **To add a stock:** search by ticker or company name, pick the right match from the results, and it joins your list showing its current price and today's percentage change.
- **To remove a stock:** select the remove action on its entry.

If a watched stock's price can't be fetched at the moment, that entry says so while the rest of the list stays current.

13. Getting Help

- The Help Centre - reached from the landing page navigation and from within the application's sidebar, located at the bottom, it contains tips on how to work and navigate this application
- Contact the team: thebigfivetb5@gmail.com.